



THE CAMEL FAMILY

Camels and their smaller South American relatives, vicuñas and guanacos, are found on sandy deserts, rocky plains, and bare mountains. They survive in some of the harshest places on Earth.

Vicuñas can breathe thin mountain air and camels can cope with freezing nights and scorching desert days. People have made good use of these animals' amazing survival skills—most are domesticated and work for a living. There are few wild members of the camel family left.

Domestic dromedary

Desert people could not survive without their one-humped camels. They are ridden, milked, and eaten. Camel skin is made into shoes, hair is woven into clothes, and dry droppings are used as fuel!



Food is brought back up from the rumen to be rechewed.

Swallow that!

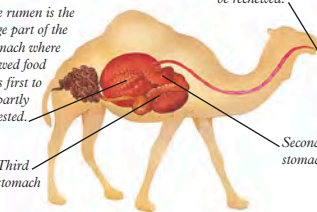
Camels can go for months without water, then drink up to 29 gallons (130 liters) of water in 13 minutes.



The rumen is the large part of the stomach where chewed food goes first to be partly digested.

Third stomach

Second stomach



Twice as tasty

To get all the goodness out of grass, some mammals, such as camels, deer, and cattle, have more than one stomach and chew their food twice!

The fat inside a camel's humps is an energy store, so it can survive a long time without food.

